2365 ACCEPTABLE USE OF GENERATIVE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI)

The Board of Education recognizes the use of artificial intelligence (AI) may result in increased and enhanced learning opportunities for students in the school district. The Board adopts this Policy to provide guidelines and expectations for student use of generative AI.

For the purpose of this Policy, "AI" means all types of generative AI technologies that create new content or outputs from a prompt to produce text, images, videos, or music.

For the purpose of this Policy, "AI tools" means software applications and platforms that utilize AI technologies to perform specific tasks and solve problems that typically require human intelligence.

For the purpose of this Policy, "assignment" means any task or work required of a student as part of a student's educational and co-curriculum program in the district.

The Board recognizes the potential of AI tools to enhance and transform a student's educational and co-curricular experience in the district. However, AI tools are not inherently knowledgeable and are trained from large amounts of data collected from various sources. Outputs generated by an AI tool may be inaccurate, inappropriate, or incomplete. Therefore, to ensure the responsible use of AI and to maintain academic integrity, students shall be required to comply with the district's Acceptable Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence Plan (AI Plan) that will include proper citation and/or documentation methods to support the content provided by an AI tool in a student assignment.

The Superintendent or designee may designate an AI Coordinator to oversee the use of all AI tools in the district and may designate additional AI Coordinators and/or committees to monitor the use of all AI tools within the district.

The Superintendent or designee, in consultation with district staff and AI Coordinator(s), shall develop the district's AI Plan.

The district's AI Plan will include details addressing the following issues:

1. A list of the schools, departments, and/or grade level(s) in the district where a staff member is authorized to permit student use of AI in assignments;

2. A procedure that requires each staff member authorized to permit students to use AI in assignments to inform the students at the time of the assignment the conditions in which AI may be used;

3. A procedure for the Superintendent or designee and the AI Coordinator(s) in the district to approve and review the use of AI tools and a process to ensure strategies will be implemented in the district to address any issues regarding student use of AI in assignments. This may include, but not be limited to, areas such as academic integrity, bias, inaccuracy/misinformation, copyright/licensing unknowns, privacy violations, and equity of access. Classroom activities involving AI tools will be monitored through monitoring platforms such as GoGuardian to ensure adherence to safe and responsible usage guidelines. Teachers will have the authority to oversee student activity and to actively address any issues that arise in real time. Students are required to report any unsafe, inappropriate, or concerning content encountered while using AI tools immediately to their teacher or another trusted adult.

4. A procedure to inform parents and receive parental consent in the beginning of each school year for the student to be permitted to use AI for assignments in accordance with this Policy and the district's AI Plan. Parents will be notified of recommended safe use practices as part of the annual consent process. The Mendham Township K-8 School District will hold periodic parent meetings and information sessions that will inform families about the educational use of AI, including its benefits, guidelines, and impact on student learning. These sessions aim to foster transparency and provide parents with the knowledge needed to support their child's experience with AI tools in education.

5. A list of prohibited uses of AI that violate this Policy or the district's Code of Student Conduct, which may include any use of AI which does not align with the conditions set when the assignment was provided to the student; using AI to complete an assignment in a way that falsely represents the assignment as the student's own; using AI to purposefully create misinformation or to misrepresent others with the intent of harming, bullying, or intimidating an individual(s); using AI with confidential student or staff personal information; and other prohibited behaviors and/or conduct listed in Policy and Regulation 2361 – Acceptable Use of Computer Networks/ Computers and Resources. Students are strictly prohibited from sharing personal information, including but not limited to names, addresses, school details, and other identifying information, when engaging with AI tools. Protecting personal privacy is essential, and failure to do so will be considered a violation of this Policy, as well as Policy and Regulation 2361 – Acceptable Use of Computer Networks/Computers and Resources.

6. A list of consequences if a student violates any provision of this Policy or AI Plan which may include, but not be limited to, the consequences listed in Policy and Regulation 2361 – Acceptable Use of Computer Networks/Computers and Resources or Policy and Regulation 5600 – Student Discipline/Code of Conduct. Violations of this Policy may also be deemed violations of the Honor Code and other applicable guidelines outlined in the MTES and MTMS Student Handbooks. Consequences for misuse of AI tools will align with disciplinary measures specified in Policy and Regulation 2361 – Acceptable Use of Computer Networks/Computers and Resources, as well as Policy and Regulation 5600 – Student Discipline/Code of Conduct.

7. A procedure to be used by a staff member to address suspected plagiarism or academic dishonesty using AI in a student's assignment in accordance with the provisions of Policy 5701;

8. A procedure to ensure a student accused of any alleged violation of the provisions of this Policy or the district's AI Plans is provided appropriate due process before making a final determination on

the student's conduct in accordance with the provisions of Policy and Regulation 5600 – Student Discipline/Code of Conduct;

9. The method(s) or format(s) to be used by students on how to cite or document content generated from any AI platform that is used in an assignment. Students should recognize that AI tools may generate inaccurate, incomplete, or biased information. It is the student's responsibility to corroborate AI-generated content with reliable sources, especially when using AI to support research or factual claims. This additional verification ensures accuracy and academic integrity in the use of AI-generated content.

The district's AI Plans will be reviewed and/or revised as needed.

In the event the Superintendent determines a provision(s) of this Policy or the district's AI Plans becomes inapplicable, inappropriate, undesirable, and/or irrelevant for any reason in the school setting, the Superintendent may revise or suspend a provision(s) of this Policy or the district's AI Plan. In such case, the Superintendent will report to the Board the reason for the revision or suspension and recommend the Board ratify the Superintendent's actions.

Adopted: 17 December 2024